Battles

How an army battle is fought: the order of multipliers, the lines, who faces whom, fortune and the result bands

Kingdoms Call reference sheet. Data file v2026.10.15-1202. Generated 2026-10-19 from the repository (branch at that date). Numbers are what the engine uses today, read straight from its tables; where a figure comes from the rulebook text instead, the section says so.

Every army battle runs the same fixed sequence. This sheet lists the multipliers in the order the engine applies them, the battle lines, the matchups and the result bands, so a unit or rule change can be traced to its effect on a fight. It complements the Army units and Terrain sheets.

What to look for when reviewing

- The stacking order (R-041): every modifier first, pre-battle damage last.
- The matchup multipliers between unit types and the line multipliers behind the front.
- The fortune curve: twice as strong wins about 80%, four times always.
- The six result bands and what each does to the loser.

Where this comes from

- Rulebook: How a Battle Is Fought; The battle, step by step; What happens to a unit on the losing side. Engine: battle/*.
- Rulings R-034, R-039, R-041, R-058, R-063, R-067, R-082 to R-084, R-089 to R-092, R-100.

The sequence

Step	What happens
1. Pre-battle duel	Opposing commanders may face each other in single combat first (a hero refuses unless told otherwise, R-107).
2. Unit strength fixed	base × quality, then per-unit: kinship (×1.2 king's kin, ×1.2 leader's kin), feud ×0.8, terrain, Illusory Terrain, Druid shortfall (−20%/level) or mastery (+20%/level), racial gifts (Elven woods ×1.5, Dwarven Bulwark ×1.5), items, unit abilities, Terror (−10% a stack), discoveries (cap ×1.30).
3. Command	Tactical ×(1 + 0.2 × level) on land and air units (cap ×2.0, land battles only); Archery +5%/level on ranged units; Naval ×(1 + 0.2 × level) on fleets and sea-beasts everywhere (cap ×2.0).
4. Whole force	Fervour (the strongest of: zeal ×1.30, Evil Monster fury ×1.25, Undead skeletal ×1.5 king / ×1.3 hero); defender's edge ×1.25 (×1.5 at the home capital; a king retaking his capital attacks at ×1.5); Good Righteous Defence +10%; Sanctuary −25%; Feigned Retreat, Grand Stratagem, Reaver Crews +25%, Raid the Coast +25%, duel morale.
5. Battle lines	Front width rolled by terrain; the side that knows the ground better lines up second and may take a wider or narrower front; each commander shifts his line once per Tactical level; the fronts always meet.
6. Battle magic	Holy Symbol, Spiritwrack, Fireball, Telekinetic Storm, Lightning Bolt, Curse, Psychic Blast, Control Undead, each at the caster's cast chance; the Thunderbirds' and other beasts' strikes (30% + 10%/Druid, cap 90%); Griffon and Wyvern strikes at 50%; Flak Screen.
7. Archery	Each ranged unit shoots 30% of its own strength (+10% per Archery level, half again at 5), at a random enemy unit (winged riders first and for double); no unit loses more than 40% to arrows (80% winged; Crossbows 55/90%). Defending Longbows loose twice; Ambush removes the phase.
8. The clash	Each front unit fights the unit opposite with the matchup multiplier; flank riders duel or ride free; the second line and reserve at their depth multipliers; flyers from the air. Totals compared.
9. Fortune	One luck swing proportional to strength: 2× wins about 80%, 3× about 90%, 4× always; 1.5× about two in three, 1.2× barely more than half.
10. Result	Margin = |winner − loser| ÷ total, giving one of six bands (below); unit deaths, quality changes, retreat, pursuit, Terror, merit, spoils, graves.

Lines and matchups

Rule	What it is
Front width	Plains and desert 6–8; forest and jungle 4–6; mountain 2–4; sea 8–10 (hulls hold the front, no flanks).
Flanks	Tactical + 1 cavalry ride free of the front on plains and desert (Stag Riders and Unicorns in woods; Ironhoof Rams in mountains). Riders pair in duels (Free Lances ×1.15); a spare rider guards a threatened end; a rider with nothing to do rides free (×1.3) and turns the flank: enemy second-line ranged units ×0.75 unless infantry anchor both ends.
Depth	Ranged unit behind a fighter: ×1 (shoots over). Anything else in the second line ×0.5, reserve ×0.25, beyond ×0.125 (Flanking Tactics lifts these). Titan Warbeasts fight from the second line at full strength.
Front matchups	Cavalry v ranged ×1.25, cavalry v infantry ×0.85 (Gilded Lances ×1.15; a Spear Hedge or Boulder Wall caps cavalry at ×0.75); infantry v cavalry ×1.15, infantry v ranged ×1.25; a ranged unit left in the front ×0.75 (Black Arrows ×1).
Shooting over	A ranged unit behind a fighter hits the enemy opposite: infantry ×1.25, cavalry ×0.75 (Longbows and Elven Bowmen differ by ability).
Wrapping	A wider front's spare units wrap the enemy's end (×1.2) and that end unit is struck from the side (×0.9), unless a spare flank rider guards it or the unit is Rooted, Hold the Gate or Unbreakable.
Flyers	Winged riders and flying beasts take no place: full strength up to the enemy's units in line and in the air (never below 2), half beyond. Archers single out the winged riders. ×0.75 under trees.
Sea	Land units ×0.75; air-carried land units ×0.25 and their carriers ×0.5; fleets, sea-beasts and flying beasts full.

Result bands

Band	Margin	Winner unit death	Loser unit death	Winner quality gain	Loser quality gain	Loser quality loss
Pyrrhic	0–4%	15%	12%	60%	20%	5%
Narrow	4–10%	12%	12%	50%	12%	10%
Clear	10–30%	5%	18%	30%	6%	20%
Decisive	30–55%	1%	35%	15%	2%	30%
Crushing	55–75%	1%	50%	8%	1%	45%
Annihilating	over 75%	1%	60%	5%	1%	55%

Rule	What it is
Per unit	Death chances are per unit, scaled by quality, +35% per carry-on round (to ×2.5), halved by Tactical 8, cut by discoveries, +6% per Free Lances (max +18%) in open country, +15% under Run Them Down, Relentless Hunt or Feeding Frenzy.
Then	A survivor rolls quality loss (a Green unit that would fall disbands) or, failing that, quality gain (Green 1.5× as likely as Average, Elite never; Humans doubled). Knightly Example spares Levies and Men-at-Arms the loss; Cave Trolls shrug off a death 30%.
Retreat	To a friendly adjacent province (never into a Flood; onto parted sea only as a last resort, R-084); a landing back to the sea it sailed from if its ships can carry it (R-058). No retreat: a further 15% per unit and the province stays contested. Shield Fort withdraws in good order; all-skeleton hosts take no flight losses.
Terror	An Evil Decisive or better win terrorises the province and its neighbours (−10% to defenders, three stacks).
Merit	+1 to the winning commander per enemy unit destroyed; −1 to the loser per own unit lost (Grand Marshal on land, Sea Lord at sea).
Spoils	Orcish attackers who win pay half wages; Pagan Blood Harvest +1g per unit destroyed; Evil Plunder 50% of tax on conquest; a consecrated province captured gives the column a 50% tier gain per unit.
Graves	The dead are left as battlefield graves (10% decay a turn, 5% Undead); disbanded units leave none; skeletons crumble to dust.

Gaps, questions and things to check

These are observations from reading the data files, the engine and the rulebook together. None of them is a ruling. Each is a question for Toby or a place where two sources disagree.

#	Observation
1	The pre-battle volley does 30% of the shooting unit's strength per shot (R-092) and the cap on arrow losses is 40% (80% winged). With Prepared Ground (two volleys) and Archery 5, defending Elite Longbows can take an attacker's front unit to the cap before the clash. Check archer-heavy defences in the balance matrix.
2	Tactical ×2.0 and Naval ×2.0 are hard caps, but kinship (×1.44), Elven woods (×1.5), Bulwark (×1.5), fervour (×1.3–1.5) and the defender's edge (×1.25–1.5) all multiply on top. A dwarven king defending his mountain capital with his own Guard is about ×1.44 × 1.5 × 1.5 × 1.1 × 2.0 before zeal: roughly ×7. Worth stating the realistic ceiling.
3	Mountain fronts of 2–4 make the Tactical line-shifts (one per level) decisive; the line-up rules are the newest part of the engine (R-089 to R-091).
4	Fortune is a fixed curve; the rulebook gives four points on it. A table of win chance by ratio would help players reading the odds the portal shows.
5	Carry-on rounds raise casualties +35% each to ×2.5, and the attacker spends a point per phase; a contested province is the one place numbers and time both matter.
6	R-082 open: Run Them Down is now a field slaughter, not a chase; is the no-chase reading final?